Abdullah Al Zahid

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Hiring Team
Exploration
Barrick Mining Corporation

Re: Canada - Geospatial Data & GIS Solutions Lead

Dear Hiring Team,

I would like to be considered for the Geospatial Data & GIS Solutions Lead position. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, with a master's degree in transportation engineering from the University of Alberta, where my thesis used GIS to study how much traffic a community's roads could carry in a wildfire evacuation.

At the City, GIS and Python are how I keep the division's data usable. I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets that Transportation Planning depends on, including a right-of-way width dataset for all city roads, built with QGIS, MapBox and JavaScript from sources that used to be scattered. I also built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought several years of survey data into one validated source in place of a report rebuilt by hand each quarter. Compiling, checking and standardizing spatial data from several sources, and automating the repetitive parts with Python and SQL, is most of what I do.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. My work has been in transportation, not in mining, geoscience or exploration, and I have not worked with remote sensing or satellite imagery. My professional GIS experience is shorter than the five years the posting asks for and is mixed in with other planning work. I have worked mainly in ArcGIS Pro and QGIS, and I have not administered ArcGIS Enterprise or Web GIS, or supported field teams with them. I have not supervised staff and I do not hold a GISP or Esri certification. I am applying because the spatial data management and Python automation is where my experience sits, and I would be glad to learn the geoscience side.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

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